Capecitabine + rectal radiotherapy

Take capecitabine twice daily on Days 1–5 of each 7-day cycle with radiotherapy, for a maximum of 5–6 cycles. Days 6–7 are not routine tablet days. Follow the team's written instructions if radiotherapy or tablets are interrupted.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Mouth

Capecitabine

Painful ulcers or reduced intake: stop tablets and call.

2 Chest

Capecitabine

New chest pain: stop tablets and seek urgent assessment.

3 Bowel / stoma

Capecitabine + radiotherapy

Significant diarrhoea, increased output or dehydration needs prompt advice.

4 Hands / feet

Capecitabine

Pain or peeling affecting daily activity: stop tablets and call.

5 Blood / infection

Capecitabine

Fever, shivers or sudden illness: contact oncology immediately.

6 Hydration / urine

Capecitabine safety

Reduced urine, dizziness or inability to drink needs assessment.

7 Pelvic skin

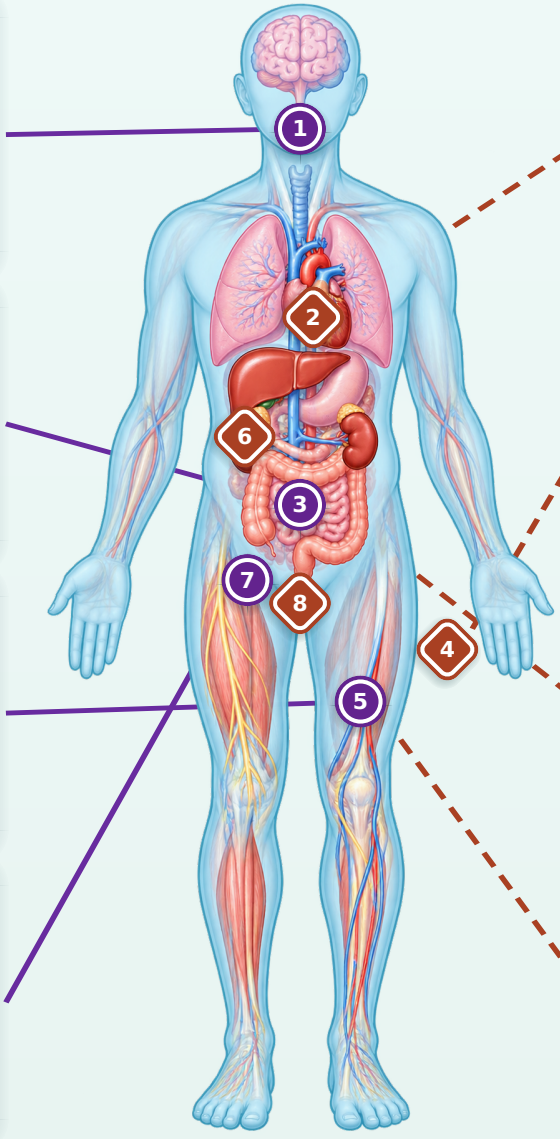
Radiotherapy

Report painful, broken or weeping skin in the treatment area.

8 Bladder / sexual health

Radiotherapy

Report urinary pain and discuss fertility and sexual effects.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Capecitabine

- Diarrhoea and dehydration
- Painful hands / feet
- Mouth soreness and reduced intake
- Low blood counts / serious infection
- Chest pain / heart problems
- Severe early toxicity, including DPD-related toxicity

Pelvic radiotherapy

- Bowel irritation / diarrhoea
- Pelvic skin soreness
- Urinary symptoms
- Fatigue
- Possible lasting bowel / bladder effects
- Sexual function / fertility effects

Chemo and radiotherapy are given together. See the treatment-course graphic or scan the QR.

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Concurrent capecitabine and pelvic radiotherapy

No automatic high/moderate IV antiemetic course for capecitabine. Written tablet-day and missed/held-dose instructions; do not double doses or extend to weekends without the team's plan. Diarrhoea/dehydration, hand-foot and pelvic skin care; nutrition and urgent-contact support.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00586/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.